

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

UPDATE - High Streamflow Advisory : Nechako River

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The BC River Forecast Centre is **maintaining a High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- Nechako River

River levels on the Nechako River have been high for the past several weeks due to rapid snowmelt and wet weather. Rio Tinto Alcan have increased discharges from the Skins Lake Spillway in order to manage reservoir levels and dam safety in response to high natural inflow rates into the Nechako Reservoir. In response to these discharges, levels on the Nechako River have been rising since June 5th. At the Water Survey of Canada gauge at Vanderhoof (08JC001) current river level is 4.46 m with a flow of 510 m³/s. RioTinto Alcan is managing discharges from the Skins Lake Spillway over the next month to achieve a target flow of 550 m³/s or less for the Nechako River at Vanderhoof. The actual discharges which occur will depend on weather conditions, rates of tributary inflows, and reservoir levels.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor stream flow conditions and provide updates as necessary.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.